

Links and Anchor Tags

Creating navigation and interactive links with the HTML anchor element.

Creating Links in HTML

HTML uses the `<a>` tag to create links. The **href** attribute tells the browser where the link should go.

Basic Syntax

```
<a href="https://www.example.com">Visit Example</a>
```

This creates a clickable link that takes you to the specified URL.

Opening Links in a New Tab

Use the **target="_blank"** attribute to open the link in a new tab.

```
<a href="https://www.google.com" target="_blank">Open Google</a>
```

Linking to Other Pages (Internal Links)

You can also link to other pages of your own website.

```
<a href="about.html">About Us</a>
```

Tip A relative path such as **about.html** can point to another page in the same website.

Link to a Section on the Same Page

Use the **id** attribute and a hash (#) to jump to a section.

```
<a href="#contact">Go to Contact</a>
```

```
<h2 id="contact">Contact Section</h2>
```

Email and Phone Links

The anchor tag can also create email and phone links.

Email Link:

```
<a href="mailto:hello@example.com">Send Email</a>
```

Phone Link:

```
<a href="tel:+1234567890">Call Us</a>
```

Styling Links (Default Behavior)

Browsers apply default visual styles to links. These styles can be changed with CSS later.

State	Default Behavior
Normal	Blue and underlined
Visited	Purple
Hover	Changes color when mouse is over it
Active	Red while clicking

Quick Reference

Task	HTML Pattern
External link	<code>Link</code>
New tab	<code>target="_blank"</code>
Internal page	<code>href="about.html"</code>
Same-page section	<code>href="#section-id"</code>
Email	<code>href="mailto:..."</code>
Phone	<code>href="tel:..."</code>

Tip Remember: the `<a>` tag creates the link, while `href` specifies its destination.

Quick Takeaway

Anchor tags are a core building block of web navigation. They can connect external websites, internal pages, sections on the same page, email addresses, and phone numbers.